

KYLE GAARDER

Community Operator | Systems Builder | Programming & Events

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Austin, Texas

SUMMARY

Community operator who builds systems from scratch. Designed and ran every aspect of a coliving community from day one - onboarding, communications, procurement, vendor management, and programming. I specialize in creating the operational backbone that makes shared spaces thrive. My approach combines hands-on facility management with intentional community design that drives retention and belonging.

*For Commune: I build community operations from zero — onboarding, programming, and retention systems that kept 94% occupancy for 19 straight months.*

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 08/2022 - 07/2024
- Austin, TX
- Built all operational systems from zero - onboarding, comms, procurement, vendor management
  - Ran 48 weekly community dinners, 4 mastermind programs, and 6 work-trade programs from scratch
  - Achieved 212% operational efficiency improvement YoY through process design and iteration
  - Maintained 94% occupancy through community-driven retention and intentional programming
  - Designed conflict-resolution and communication systems supporting long-term resident satisfaction
- Directed full-cycle facility ops from financial reporting to vendor procurement and maintenance
- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition to Macro House while maintaining community continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 01/2021 - 08/2022
- Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots community outreach
  - Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand community needs and validate programming
  - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
  - Led operations, partnerships, and community concept development in early-stage environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 01/2011 - 01/2016
- Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
  - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
  - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
  - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
  - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 212% Efficiency Improvement**  
Year-over-year operational efficiency gains through systematic process design and iteration
- 48 Community Programs Built**  
Designed and ran 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 work-trade programs from a blank slate
- 94% Occupancy via Community**  
Community-driven retention sustained 94% occupancy for 19 months in an emerging model
- Investor Pilot Secured**  
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community housing concept across 5 states
- Demand Pipeline Built**  
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through concept validation and outreach

SKILLS

- Community Programming
- Systems Design from Zero
- Facility Operations    Vendor Procurement
- Event Planning    Facilitation
- Conflict Resolution    Comms
- Partnerships    Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology

Virginia Tech

08/2010 - 05/2014

Virginia, USA

- Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish
- GPA

3.5 / 4.0